

Green practices at the Taj Hotels and Resorts

It's great to learn that green tech and clean energy initiatives aren't confined to one particular sector or industry at large. Because signs of a healthy, universal trend is when it finds widespread acceptability and adoption. Doing its bit for the environment is Taj Hotels and Resorts, an old name in India's hospitality sector and part of Tata Group, one of the largest company in India.

It's heartening to see that Taj Hotels and Resorts take green initiatives similar to servicing their guests and make them feel at home. Very few people know this but since 2010 the Taj group of hotels and resorts conform to green practices decreed by the Green Globe Standard (<http://dgit.in/O3GUIW>). This includes greener initiatives for waste management, conserving energy and eco-sensitivity assessed by an independent audit every three years.

Kitchen waste and dry leaves from the hotels is converted into compost and waste paper is recycled for writing pads. Not only do all Taj hotels use CFL lights, which consume close to 80 per cent less energy than incandescent bulbs, there are a few special cases of advanced green initiatives. According to a report, the Taj Coromandel in Chennai generates considerable energy through windmills, while Taj West End in Bangalore's solar water heating systems has helped save over 51,000 litres of fuel in the past three years. Taj's hotel at Rambagh Palace, Jaipur has a fully-functional biogas plant.

Moser Baer's solar arm

We've all held a Moser Baer CD or DVD in our hand at some point of our life, haven't we? Yet, very few people know that Moser Baer's an Indian brand, even fewer know that it has a dedicated arm developing photovoltaic silicon cells since 2007. Surprised? So were we. Since its inception, the company has achieved several milestones and successfully completed solar array installations in a variety of countries across the world. Although it's fighting stiff competition from Chinese and American manufacturers in an emerging energy sector, it's great to know about a household name that should, if it weather's the storm, provide photovoltaic cells needed for solar panels at an affordable cost, thereby boosting the widespread acceptability of solar energy initiatives. 